

Ian Reid believes that the Commonwealth Games' Directors' objectives should be to prioritise jobs and investment when making business decisions. However, others have suggested that the objectives should meet the needs of all stakeholders.

Using the data in Extracts A to D, evaluate these two objectives and recommend which is more appropriate for the 2022 Commonwealth Games' Directors.

Extract A

Commonwealth Games, Birmingham, 2022

Durban, South Africa, was due to stage the Commonwealth Games 2022 but withdrew due to financial and practical concerns. Bids were also submitted by Edmonton, Canada and Liverpool, but the Commonwealth Games Foundation (CGF), chose Birmingham, the UK's second biggest city.

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Over 1,000 people will be recruited to deliver Birmingham 2022. Job vacancies will include roles related to administration, planning, marketing and security. Recruitment and training of staff will be led by Gi Group, a world leader in human resource management.

Gi Group will deliver comprehensive recruitment services and fill over 1,000 roles across multiple specialisms, including selection, training and on-the-job support. Gi Group will also assist all Birmingham 2022 staff with developing their careers from August 2022, once the Games are over.

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(Source: adapted from <https://birmingham2022.gigroup.com/about>)

Extract B

Huge progress at the Birmingham 2022 Alexander Athletics Stadium

Since planning permission was granted in January 2020, the demolition of three existing stands at the Perry Park site has been completed and work has started on rebuilding the stands with steelwork from British companies.

The £184m scheme remains on budget and scheduled for completion in spring 2022, ahead of its initial use as the venue for the Commonwealth Games athletics competition.

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After the Games, the stadium is set to become a focal point of health, wellbeing, sport, academic and community activity as part of a £500m City of Birmingham Regeneration Scheme.

The stadium, which will hold around 30,000 spectators at each session during the Games, will switch to a permanent capacity of around 18,000 post-Games – the largest permanent facility capable of hosting international athletics in the UK. Furthermore, it will continue to be the home of the world-famous Birchfield Harriers Athletics Club.

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(Source: adapted from <https://www.birmingham2022.com/news/blog/hugely-encouraging-progress-at-birmingham-2022-alexander-stadium/>)

Extract C

Capital funding and business partnerships for 2022 Commonwealth Games

Project	Cost (£m)	Main source(s)
Alexander Athletics Stadium redevelopment	184	Central Government and Sport England (£112m), Birmingham City Council (£27m), Local Enterprise Partnership (£20m), West Midlands Authority (£25m)
Sandwell Aquatics Centre, Smethwick (New build)	73	Central Government, Sandwell Council, Local Enterprise Partnership, Sport England, and Sandwell Leisure Trust
Smithfield Arena (New build)	64	Central Government, Birmingham City Council, West Midlands Authority
Coventry Stadium adaptations	32	Central Government, Coventry City Council
National Exhibition Centre adaptations	25	Central Government, West Midlands Authority
Other sites and infrastructure	400	Sport England, Business Partners/ Sponsorships
Total	778	

(Source: adapted from <https://www.birmingham2022.com/business/partnerships>, www.sandwell.gov.uk and <https://www.birmingham2022.com/news/blog/hugely-encouraging-progress-at-birmingham-2022-alexander-stadium/>)

Extract D

Commonwealth Games vision and mission (Extracts from)

Ian Reid, Birmingham 2022 Chief Executive Officer stated: "In order to deliver this iconic celebration of sport we need to forge dynamic, new business partnerships. The Games will boost jobs and investment and promote Birmingham's national and international reputation."

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The Birmingham 2022 Commonwealth Games will

- Embrace and drive the youth, diversity, humanity and pride of the region and the 76 countries of the Commonwealth.
- Inspire, engage and connect communities and athletes to realise their full potential and live happier, healthier lives.
- Drive sustainable economic growth and aspiration; creating opportunities through trade, investment, jobs and skills.
- Transform and strengthen local communities, working together to deliver new and improved homes, facilities and transport links.

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(Source: adapted from <https://www.birmingham2022.com/about-us/our-purpose/>)

Number	Indicative content	Mark
1(d)	Knowledge 4, Application 4, Analysis 6, Evaluation 6 Marks for application and analysis include up to 4 marks for quantitative skills Quantitative skills assessed: QS8: use and interpret quantitative and non-quantitative information in order to make decisions QS9: interpret, apply and analyse information in written, graphical and numerical form. - Stakeholders are those people or groups who have an interest in the actions of a business. They include owners, employees, customers (spectators), suppliers, the local community, pressure groups (Sport England), local (Sandwell) and central government. Directors' objectives of jobs and investment - Government expects to receive a return on their investments, e.g. £112m towards the cost of the Alexandra Athletics Stadium redevelopment - Given the overall cost of the Games (£778m capital cost alone), directors would prioritise the recovery of the capital cost - Opportunities to make profits from the Games to be regarded as successful, e.g. through hospitality and catering. Especially welcome given the economic downturn in the UK - Opportunities for longer term returns from the continued use of venues such as the 18,000 capacity stadium	

Other stakeholder objectives

- It is a well-documented legacy of other international sporting events, e.g. the London Olympics, that by hosting events you encourage the regeneration of the local area through new housing and better infrastructure
- Birchfield Harriers and the local sports community will have improved facilities which should help improve the performance of and outcomes for the athletes.
- Local councillors may believe that athletes provide a role model to society to live healthily. This could have positive consequences for the local community and society as a whole
- The Games should represent an opportunity to upgrade the UK venues to make them fit for purpose and possibly host international events.

Possible recommendation

- Inevitably there will be conflicts between stakeholder groups. You might argue in this instance that the shareholders are the public sector organisations who have given a significant amount of funding towards the Games so there needs to be longer term benefits to the UK economy and Birmingham community
- It is important to keep key stakeholders interests in mind, otherwise the Games might not have taken place given a potential lack of funding, e.g. Government and local

Examples of possible 'MOPS' recommendations

Market – The Games may provide more opportunities for smaller businesses to thrive and contribute to the overall economy due to the extra visitors. This links to the Directors' objectives of jobs and investment

Objectives – The Games 'Vision and Mission' is clearly about meeting the needs of a range of stakeholders which is what enabled Birmingham and the UK to be chosen to host the Games in 2022

Product – Facilities will naturally be improved or newly built (Sandwell Aqua Centre) which will benefit athletes in the short term but the community of Sandwell in the longer term

Situation – the growth in obesity and sedentary lifestyles means the Games can be used to reduce this by highlighting the importance of local people participating in sports

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